

THE CHAMELEON

Chamaeleon



SIZE RANKING 79

BRIGHTEST STARS Alpha (α) 4.1, Gamma (γ) 4.1

GENITIVE Chamaeleontis

ABBREVIATION Cha

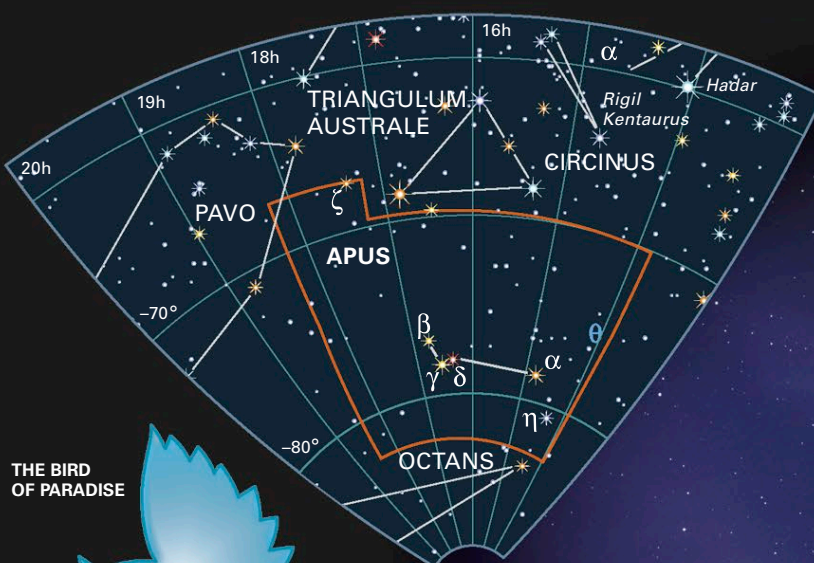
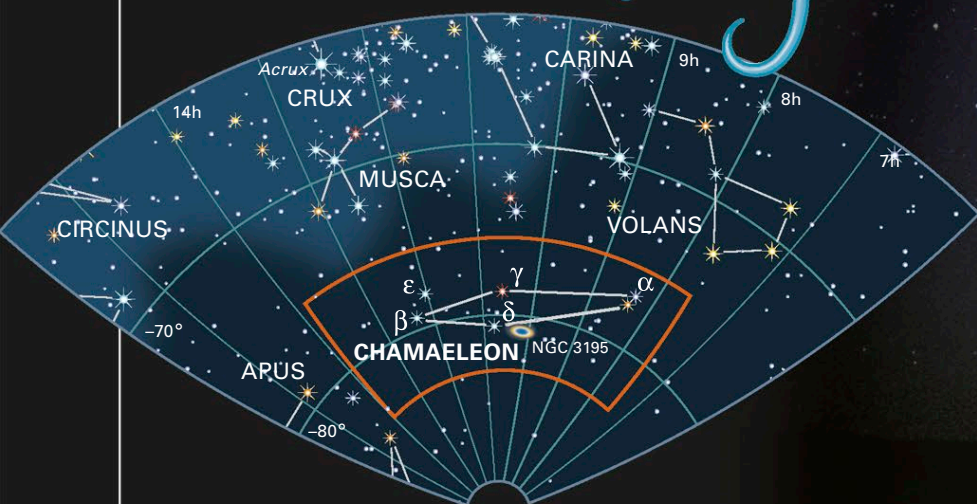
HIGHEST IN SKY AT 10 PM February–May

FULLY VISIBLE 7°N–90°S

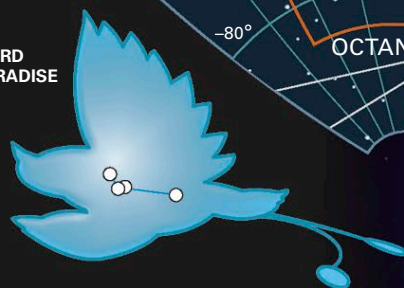


Chamaeleon was named after the lizard that can change its skin color to match its surroundings. It is a small, faint constellation of the south polar region of the sky.

THE CHAMELEON



THE BIRD OF PARADISE



EXOTIC BIRD

Apus, which is south of the distinctive Triangulum Australe, represents a bird of paradise but is a disappointing tribute to such an exotic bird.

CAMOUFLAGE ARTIST

Chamaeleon lies close to the south celestial pole, which is to the left of it in this picture. To the north of this constellation are found the rich Milky Way star fields of Carina.

THE BIRD OF PARADISE

Apus



SIZE RANKING 67

BRIGHTEST STAR Alpha (α) 3.8

GENITIVE Apodis

ABBREVIATION Aps

HIGHEST IN SKY AT 10 PM May–July

FULLY VISIBLE 7°N–90°S



The constellation Apus is situated in the almost featureless area around the south celestial pole. It was invented in the late 16th century by the Dutch navigator–astronomers Pieter Dirkszoon Keyser and Frederick de Houtman (see p.416).

SPECIFIC FEATURES

Delta (δ) Apodis is a wide pair of unrelated 5th-magnitude red giants, while Theta (θ) Apodis is a red giant that varies somewhat erratically between 5th and 7th magnitudes every 4 months or so.